Hamidreza Saffari

Ph.D. Student · LMU Munich (SODA Lab) · Munich, Germany
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Education

Ludwig-Maximilians-Universität München (LMU Munich) Fall 2026 –
Ph.D. in Social Data Science and AI, SODA Lab *Munich, Germany*

Politecnico di Milano Sep 2023 – Jul 2026
M.Sc. in Computer Science and Engineering, Artificial Intelligence Track *Milan, Italy*

- **Academic Standing:** GPA: 110L/110 with Honors.
- **M.Sc. Thesis:** Auditing Exposure to Harmful Content on TikTok using Multimodal Language Models. **[arXiv:2608.17583]**

Shahid Beheshti University Sep 2018 – Feb 2023
B.Sc. in Computer Engineering *Tehran, Iran*

- **Academic Standing:** GPA: 17.49 / 20.
- **Undergraduate Thesis:** Graph Embedding Learning for Link Prediction in Dynamic Graphs via Autoencoders.

Publications

(* indicates equal contribution, + indicates co-second/co-contributing authorship)

1. **Saffari, H.**, Pierri, F. *"Auditing Exposure to Harmful Content on TikTok using Multimodal Language Models: A Cross-National, Age-Stratified Study"*. **arXiv preprint (2026)**, M.Sc. thesis. **[arXiv:2608.17583]**
2. **Saffari, H.***, Shafiei, M.*, Zhang, H., Harris, L. T., Moosavi, N. S. *"Beyond Hate Speech: NLP's Challenges and Opportunities in Uncovering Dehumanizing Language"*. **EMNLP 2025**. **[ACL Anthology]**
3. **Saffari, H.***, Shafiei, M.*, Rooein, D., Pierri, F., Nozza, D. *"Can I introduce my boyfriend to my grandmother? Evaluating Large Language Models Capabilities on Iranian Social Norm Classification"*. **NAACL 2025**. **[ACL Anthology]**
4. **Saffari, H.***, Shafiei, M.*, Rooein, D., Nozza, D. *"Measuring Gender Bias in Language Models in Farsi"*. **GeBNLP @ ACL 2025**. **[ACL Anthology]**
5. Shafiei, M.*, **Saffari, H.***, Pilehvar, M. T., Raganato, A. *"TruthTrap: A Bilingual Benchmark for Evaluating Factually Correct Yet Misleading Information in Question Answering"*. **EACL 2026**. **[ACL Anthology]**
6. Shafiei, M.*, **Saffari, H.***, Moosavi, N. S. *"Framing Bias in Arithmetic Reasoning: How Language and Identity Cues Steer LLM Outputs in Objective Tasks"*. **EMNLP 2026**. **[arXiv:2506.03923]**
7. Chang, T. A.*, Arnett, C.*, Eldesokey, A., Sadallah, A., Kashar, A., Daud, A., …, **Saffari, H.**, … *"Global PIQA: Evaluating Physical Commonsense Reasoning Across 100+ Languages and Cultures"*. **NeurIPS 2026**. **[arXiv:2510.24081]**
8. Shafiei, M.*, **Saffari, H.***, Moosavi, N. S. *"LingAlign: A Multilingual, Multidimensional Benchmark for Evaluating LLM Alignment Variability"*. **Preprint (2026)**.
9. Shafiei, M.*, **Saffari, H.***, Moosavi, N. S. *"MultiHoax: A Dataset of Multi-hop False-Premise Questions"*. **ACL 2025**. **[ACL Anthology]**
10. Shafiei, M.*, **Saffari, H.*** *"Not All Jokes Land: Evaluating Large Language Models Understanding of Workplace Humor"*. **arXiv preprint (2025)**. **[arXiv:2506.01819]**
11. Salimi-Badr, A., Hashemi, M., **Saffari, H.** *"A type-2 neuro-fuzzy system with a novel learning method for Parkinson's disease diagnosis"*. **Applied Intelligence (Springer, 2023)**. **[Springer]**
12. Atari, M., Davani, A., **Saffari, H.**+, Shafiei, M.+, Bolandi, A.+ *"PsyEmbedding: Fine-tuning Pre-trained Transformer Models for Quantifying Psychological Similarity in Text"*. **Under Submission (2026)**.

13. Bolandi, A.*, **Saffari, H.***, Shafiei, M.*, Vahidi-Asl, M. *"Software Defect Prediction Using Visualization Techniques and Convolutional Neural Networks".*

Research Experience

Research Assistant Dec 2023 – July 2026
Politecnico di Milano · MilaNLP Lab *Milan, Italy*

- Investigating cultural alignment, demographic disparities, and social norm perception in frontier LLMs under the supervision of Prof. Debora Nozza and Prof. Francesco Pierri.
- Designed and benchmarked the Iranian Social Norms (ISN) dataset to evaluate cross-cultural behavioral alignment of LLMs across English and low-resource languages (NAACL 2025).
- Conducted empirical audits on gender bias in Farsi language models, formulating standardized demographic evaluation protocols for representation harms (GeBNLP @ ACL 2025).

Research Assistant Oct 2024 – Oct 2025
University of Sheffield *Sheffield, UK (Remote)*

- Collaborated with Dr. Nafise Sadat Moosavi on reasoning robustness, adversarial vulnerability, and dehumanizing language detection in LLMs.
- Benchmarked frontier LLMs on complex multi-hop deductive reasoning and verified failure modes in multi-step planning (MultiHoax @ ACL 2025).
- Investigated subtle manifestations of dehumanizing and hate speech in automated content moderation systems (EMNLP 2025).

Research Assistant Oct 2023 – Sep 2024
University of Massachusetts Amherst *Amherst, MA, USA (Remote)*

- Researched computational psychology and automated psychometric text representations in collaboration with Dr. Mohammad Atari.
- Fine-tuned domain-adapted transformer architectures (*PsyEmbedding*) to quantify psychological and behavioral similarity across multi-domain textual corpora.

Research Intern Jun 2022 – Aug 2022
Institute for Research in Fundamental Sciences (IPM) *Tehran, Iran*

- Conducted systems-level profiling and runtime acceleration of transformer self-attention mechanisms under Dr. Dara Rahmati.
- Benchmarked computational execution pipelines using middle-level languages to reduce inference memory footprints on hardware accelerators.

Undergraduate Research Assistant Sep 2019 – Feb 2023
Shahid Beheshti University *Tehran, Iran*

- Developed an interpretable interval type-2 fuzzy neural network framework for diagnosing Parkinson's disease from clinical gait cycles, published in *Applied Intelligence* (Springer).
- Formulated dynamic graph representation learning techniques using Siamese networks and deep autoencoders for temporal link prediction.
- Built an end-to-end software defect prediction framework converting source code into visual representations for CNN-based classification.

Work Experience

Artificial Intelligence Engineer Nov 2025 – Present
Guida e Vai Srl *Milan, Italy*

- Developing and deploying multimodal LLM agents for adaptive candidate evaluation and skill assessment in production. Building scalable data processing and inference pipelines integrated with production web services.

Machine Learning Engineer Feb 2023 – Aug 2023
Wallex Co. *Tehran, Iran*

- Engineered conversational AI agents leveraging LLM APIs, function calling/tool use, and RAG architectures; implemented safety verification guardrails to eliminate hallucinations.

Software Engineer (Part-Time) Feb 2023 – Aug 2023
Behsa Co. *Tehran, Iran*

- Designed and implemented scalable backend REST APIs and asynchronous data streaming pipelines using Java and Spring Boot.

Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistant & Team Leader Sep 2019 – Feb 2023
Shahid Beheshti University · Department of Computer Science & Engineering *Tehran, Iran*

- **Graduate Level:** Machine Learning (Fall 2022).
- **Undergraduate Level:** Introduction to Machine Learning, Fundamentals of Robotics (Team Leader), Embedded Real-Time Systems (Team Leader, 2 terms), Computer Architecture (Team Leader, 2 terms), Advanced Programming (Team Leader, 2 terms), Microprocessors & Assembly (Team Leader, 3 terms), Digital Circuit Design, Introduction to Programming.
- Held weekly recitation sessions, designed homework assignments and programming projects in Python and C++, and led teams of 4–8 teaching assistants.

Academic Service & Reviewing

Program Committee:

- AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence (**AAAI 2027**).

Reviewer:

- **Conferences:** AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence (**AAAI 2026**).
- **Workshops:** 6th Workshop on Gender Bias in NLP (**GeBNLP @ ACL 2025**), Workshop on Online Abuse and Harms (**WOAH @ ACL 2025**), Social Simulations (**Social Sim @ COLM 2025**), **INTERPLAY @ COLM 2025**, AI Alignment (**AIA @ COLM 2025**).

Technical Skills

Programming Languages: Python, Java, Go (Golang), C/C++, Bash, SQL, SystemVerilog, VHDL
Machine Learning & NLP: PyTorch, Hugging Face (Transformers, Datasets, PEFT), TensorFlow, Scikit-learn, LangChain, NLTK, Pandas, NumPy
Infrastructure & Tools: Git, Docker, Linux, Weights & Biases, MongoDB, Spring Boot, LaTeX
Spoken Languages: English (Proficient, TOEFL iBT: 111/120), Persian (Native), Italian (Elementary)

Selected Coursework

Graduate (Politecnico di Milano): Deep Learning (A+), Natural Language Processing (A+), Machine Learning (A+), Data Mining (A+)
Undergraduate (Shahid Beheshti University): Artificial Intelligence & Expert Systems (A), Robotics (A+), Advanced Programming (A+), Software Hardware Co-design (A+), Embedded & Real-Time Systems (A+), Computer Architecture (A+)